

Weather May Postpone Miner Baseball Start

Rain, cold, and snow do not make good baseball weather, so the University of Texas at El Paso may have its 1973 season opener knocked out Friday afternoon.

Coach Andy Cohen's Miners are slated to start the season against Hardin-Simmons with a 1 p.m. doubleheader at Dudley Field, but Cohen said Thursday night he didn't think Dudley was in playing condition.

"We'll check out the field Friday," Cohen said. "It's doubtful that we'll play. The field is really a mess."

Williamson Ranks High In Stats

NEW YORK (AP) — New Mexico State's John Williamson is ranked among the nation's leading scorers again.

The Aggie junior, who was suspended by the NCAA but reinstated by the courts, is seventh in scoring with a 27.5 points per game average in the latest NCAA statistics.

Pepperdine's William "Bird" Averitt continues to lead the country with a 34.1 average, followed by Raymond Lewis of Cal State-Los Angeles

If wet grounds do cause a postponement, there'll be a Saturday doubleheader at 1 p.m. at Dudley.

Cohen looks for improvement over last year's 12-39 record. The Miners have first baseman Barry Alburtis, a senior from Lubbock, back. At .335, Alburtis was the only regular who hit over .300 for the season in 1972.

"We'll have a better club this year," Andy went on. "I think our pitching will be better, our defense will be improved, especially in the infield, and we'll have more speed."

Ray Greggerson, an El Paso sophomore, will start the Miners' opener, whenever it comes. Cohen was unsure of the rest of his rotation against Hardin-Simmons.

One new feature this season will be the designated pinch hitter, in effect for all WAC league games. In non-league games, the DPH will be used by mutual consent of the two coaches.

"I don't think it will change the game too much. It will help a pitcher stay in a close game longer, but it won't affect the game so much," Cohen added.

This season will be U.T. El Paso's 11th intercollegiate baseball campaign, all under Cohen. The Miners have a 179-198-1 won-lost-tied record.